

Engineering Team Meeting Minutes — How To Use

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1. Overview

This is a meeting minutes and action tracking system built in Excel. Take notes during the meeting, mark anything that needs follow-up as **ACTION** or **RISK**, and use the AR view to see all open actions filtered.

Compared to the old version: no checkboxes (use the Type dropdown), no separate Action Register sheet (it's a filter view of Meeting Minutes), no two-way sync to break, and project structure is driven by where rows sit on the sheet.

2. The sheets

Sheet	What it does
Summary	High-level dashboard view (action counts by owner / status). Optional — review before each meeting if useful.
Meeting Minutes	Where you take notes during the meeting and where actions live. The main working sheet.
Risk Register	Standalone register of project risks. Populated manually as risks are flagged.
How To Use	Quick cheat sheet inside the file. Same content as this guide.
Changelog	Version history of the template. Locked.

3. Meeting Minutes structure

Header block (rows 1–14)

Title, location, date, attendees, keyboard shortcuts panel. Don't edit the structure here — just update the date and tick off attendees each meeting.

Column headers (row 15)

Col	Header	What it holds
A	Type	Dropdown: Action / Risk / blank. Blank = general note. Drives the row's CF.
B	Description	What was discussed. One clear point per row.
C	Owner	Dropdown: TM1 / TM2 / TM3 / TM4 / TM5 / TM6 / ALL.
D	Due	Date the action must be done. DD/MM/YYYY.
E	Status	Dropdown: Open / In Progress / Done / On Hold / Waiting.
F	Priority	Dropdown: Critical / High / Medium / Low.
G	Days OD	Auto-calculated days overdue. Blank if not overdue or not an action.
H	Notes / Update	Free text. Use for weekly progress or context.
I	Project (hidden)	Project name on every row. Used by AR view filter. Filled by AddRow / AddProject macros.
J	Date Added (hidden)	Auto-stamped on row creation by AddRow. Never overwritten.

Banners

Two banner levels stacked above each project's data rows:

- **Lifecycle banner** (full-width, dark colour): TEAM, ACTIVE PROJECTS, DLP PROJECTS, FUTURE PROJECTS, STRATEGIC, GENERAL BUSINESS, CLOSED PROJECTS.
- **Project banner** (full-width, light blue): one per project under its lifecycle. E.g. "Project A".

Lifecycle = where a project sits in the sheet. To move a project from Active to DLP: select the project's banner + all its data rows, cut, paste under the DLP banner. No macro needed.

4. Colour code guide

Lifecycle banners

Banner	Fill
TEAM	#444441

- ACTIVE PROJECTS #1F3864
- DLP PROJECTS #0F6E56
- FUTURE PROJECTS #185FA5
- STRATEGIC #534AB7
- GENERAL BUSINESS #5F5E5A
- CLOSED PROJECTS #5F5E5A

Project banners

Light blue: #B5D4F4 fill, dark blue text #042C53 .

Row CF rules

Rule	Triggered by	Result
Action row	Type = Action	Pale navy fill #E1E9F3
Overdue	Type = Action AND Due past today AND Status not Done/On	Pale red fill #FBE0E0 (overrides
Action	Hold/Waiting	pale navy)
Risk row	Type = Risk	Pale orange fill #FFF1DD

Status pill (col E)

- Open #EEF4FA / #5C7FA1 text
- In Progress #FFF2CC / #9C7700 text
- Done #E5F1D9 / #5F8F37 text
- On Hold #FCE5EA / #A85871 text
- Waiting #F1E8F7 / #7E5BA4 text

Priority pill (col F)

- Critical #C00000 / white text
- High #ED7D31 / white text
- Medium #FFC000 / #7D5200 text
- Low #A9D18E / #375623 text

5. Weekly workflow

Tuesday — during the meeting

1. Open the file from the synced SharePoint folder. Update the date in the header.

2. Tick off attendees in the attendees table.
3. Take minutes row by row. **Ctrl + Shift + A** adds a new row under the current project. **Ctrl + Shift + P** adds a new project banner if needed.
4. For anything requiring follow-up, set **Type = Action**. Fill in Owner, Due, Status, Priority. Row turns amber automatically.
5. For anything that's a risk to flag, set **Type = Risk**.
6. Save the file.

Tuesday to Monday — during the week

1. Open the file. Use the Action Register filter button (or run ShowARView macro) to see only your actions.
2. Update Status as you complete actions. Add notes in col H if helpful.
3. If new risks come up, add them to the Risk Register tab directly.
4. Save when done.

Next Tuesday — before the meeting

1. Open the file. Click **Hide / Show Done** button to declutter (hides Done rows).
2. Review the Summary tab — see who has outstanding actions.
3. Take this week's minutes continuing from where you left off.

6. Keyboard shortcuts & macros

Shortcut	What it does
Ctrl + Shift + A	AddRow — insert a new row below the cursor with project name pre-filled.
Ctrl + Shift + P	AddProject — insert a new project banner below the cursor (prompts for project name).

Buttons

Button	What it does
Hide / Show Done	Toggles Done rows on Meeting Minutes.
AR View	Filters Meeting Minutes to show only Action rows.
Restore Full View	Unhides everything.
Hide / Show Closed (Risk Register)	Toggles Closed risks.

7. Troubleshooting

Problem	Fix
Row not turning amber	Check Type column (col A) — must be exactly "Action" from the dropdown.
AddRow inserts in the wrong place	Click a data row first (row 16+), then run. It inserts above the active row.
Action Register filter not showing my row	Check that col I (Project) is filled. AR view filters by Project, so blank Project rows are hidden.
Ctrl+Shift+A doesn't work	Macro not bound. Alt+F8 → AddRow → Options → assign Ctrl+Shift+A. Open Manage Rules (Home → Conditional Formatting → Manage Rules).
Status / Priority colour wrong	Make sure Status/Priority cell rules are above the row-level rules in priority order.
File saving to wrong place	Always open from the synced SharePoint folder in File Explorer, not from the browser.
Macro security warning	Click Enable Content in the yellow bar at the top.

Need to dig deeper? Anything not in this guide — check with Adina or open the macro archive HTML for the technical history.